TOP 10 MODEL COMPOS

BASED ON COMMON EXAM TOPICS

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A little Introduction…

Thanks for downloading this ebook 😊

I am Jerry Lee, Founder of **WritingSamurai.com**, and Director at **Grade Solution Learning Centre**. WritingSamurai.com is an online learning site where your child can learn from our online courses, while Grade Solution Learning Centre is our physical tuition centre - we currently have branches at Bugis, Kovan, and Clementi.

The compositions you see here are written by our students (online and offline), and we've picked the most creative and interesting stories from the previous year. These compos have been edited for minor grammar mistakes or inaccurate vocabulary used. But most of the content remains originally written by our students. (If you spot any mistakes in the compos, do write in to us about the error and we will edit it immediately.)

To summarise our teaching methods, we simply teach your child to **write AWESOME compos without memorising bombastic words or phrases**. We have a lesson plan to guide your child from writing the intro all the way to the conclusion, and we will also train your child in all the technical aspects of writing like vocab, grammar, and variation of sentence structure.

We don't promise 'miracle' improvements, but if your child has a good learning attitude, and is able to apply the concepts taught, he or she has a chance of being one of the top writers in class. (No kidding!) You can see the testimonials on our Facebook page here >>> https://www.facebook.com/writingsamurai/

Anyway, to get the most out of these model compos, you should study how our students phrase their words, or choose the most effective vocabulary to describe a scene. Observe how they write intros, build up the climax and end the story in unique ways that leave deep impressions on you.

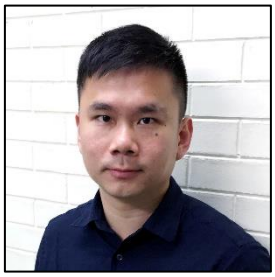
Read. Learn. Apply.

Then practise a couple of times.

Soon, you will get the hang of it; and hopefully one day, we can publish your compositions in the next edition of our model compositions book too.

But for now, just sit back, relax, and enjoy these stories!

Cheers,



Jerry Lee

Saving Students, One Word at a Time.

P.S: To the students who wrote these compos, thank you for your effort. We had a great time teaching you, and we wish you success in your future endeavours.

P.P.S: If you wish to find out more about how you can help your child write better, go to the last few pages of this book.

Topic: Pride

Pictures given: A boy looking proud, a trophy, an exam/test script showing an 'A' grade

Every time I look at the old result slip that I have stuck to the wall, I remember how arrogant I was about my cleverness, and I feel ashamed.

I was proud of myself for acing all my Math tests. I was the best in class at Math and had never scored less than ninety marks. There was another boy in my class named Tim. He had never been able to keep up with his work or pass any test we had. We always called him "Stupid" or "No Brains". Little did I know he was going to show me who the real "No Brain" was.

One day, we got back our latest Math test paper. As expected, I got full marks, whereas Tim failed, as usual. My teacher, Mr. Yap, did not scold him for failing, but praised him and told him he could do better next time.

That day I could not hold back what I wanted to say any more.

I stood up and exclaimed, "Why are you praising him, Sir? He has always been failing his Math. Shouldn't you be scolding him?"

The whole class turned to look at me, and Mr. Yap, with a furious face, told me in an icy cold voice, "David, meet me during recess in the staff room."

I knew I was in deep trouble and now had to face the music.

I knocked timidly at the staff room door. When I went in, Mr. Yap smiled kindly and told me to take a seat. I was confused. "Isn't he going to scold me?" I wondered.

He explained, "The reason I am not scolding you is because Tim told me not to."

"But I have been insulting him all the time!"

"He actually has a reason why he cannot pass his tests. It all started ten years ago. His father passed away when he was only two years old. Now he is big enough to help his mother with the chores and serve at her food stall. He has little time to study."

All this time, I had been filled with pride of myself and had never thought about others.

That day, I decided to help Tim instead of laughing at him. I hung out with him as much as I could. Soon after, with my coaching, Tim went from an F to a B+ for his Math. That is why I have Tim's result slip stuck on my wall. It reminds me of how I gained a new friend and learnt an important lesson about being too proud.

By Brian Chua, P6

Topic: An Unlucky Event

Pictures given: A boat, Huge waves, A fishing rod

"I wished I had never come out to sea today!" exclaimed John as he sat in his boat out in the stormy sea.

Earlier that morning, the sun shone brilliantly, and the water glittered invitingly. The sea bathed in a golden hue and the water was as clear as crystal. It was a good weather for fishermen to fish.

Tom and Johnny had decided to go fishing and began pushing the boat into the waters. Soon, they were out in the open sea. They were prepared for a good catch as they had previously found a good spot for fishing. In the blink of an eye, they had reached the location and they threw their fishing net into the water.

About twenty minutes later, they retrieved the net with all their might and emptied the contents into the boat.

"Wow! We'll get a good profit if this carries on!" exclaimed John.

Johnny nodded his head with delight and cast their net again. Just when Johnny threw out the net the second time, the sky turned ominous grey, threatening to rain. A bolt of lightning tore across the horizon and a peal of thunder followed. Anxious frowns creased the two fishermen's foreheads. A thunderstorm is a fisherman's worst nightmare. Within seconds, foreboding black clouds loomed overhead and they released sudden showers. Lightning and thunder raged with fury as gigantic waves crashed around the two poor souls.

Both fishermen trembled in fear and their hearts thumped erratically even though they had been trained on how to survive in an emergency such as this. They looked at each other with petrified expressions. They were facing death in the eye. The goal of catching more fish was totally erased from their minds as fear took over. They were

powerless to mother nature and cold terror gripped their hearts. They paddled furiously against the waves, but their efforts were futile.

Huge waves overwhelmed their tiny boat and the water was choppier than ever. The boat was tossed around like a toy and soon, it capsized. The men floundered helplessly, and they tried to hang on to the boat. They were running out of energy and hope. They saw their lives flash before their eyes. They called out each other's names. Soon, they gave up their struggle to remain afloat and succumbed to the huge waves which devoured them mercilessly.

The next morning, two pale bloated bodies were found near an overturned boat.

The high sunlit clouds drifted across the clear blue sky, brightening the emerald sea. This was the perfect weather for everyone. But for the family of Tom and Johnny, the beauty was lost on them.

Lim Ye Zhuo, P6

Topic: A Special Gift

Pictures given: A friend giving a gift, A mug with the words 'Best Friends', a Jersey.

Basketball was my passion. I would hang out at the basketball court after school every day. I loved the feeling of being airborne and slamming the ball into the basket. I loved the feeling of being swooned over by girls when they saw me play. To make it even better, my best friend Jimmy and I were both on the school team. We would always practise together and challenge each other. However, one day, things took a turn for the worse…

As usual, after training, I was walking home and dribbling my basketball at the same time. By accident, the ball bounced onto my toe and hurtled away from my outstretched hand.

"No!" I had bought that basketball with my hard-earned savings!

Without thinking, I dashed after it and onto the road.

"Hey, look out!" a voice shouted.

I spun around, but it was too late. A car was coming in my direction. It could not stop in time.

"Bang!"

I flew and landed painfully in a heap like a rag doll. Everything became blurry, and I could feel the pain radiating through my legs. I tried to get up, but my legs could barely move.

"Ugh," I groaned, my face contorting in pain.

"Are you alright? I will send you to the hospital immediately," said the driver, who had gotten out of the car and was kneeling beside me, worry written across his face.

At the hospital, Dr Lee checked me for my injuries and said, “Jerry, your right leg is broken. You will need to be in a cast, and it may take up to 3 months for you to recover. Even then, you may not be able to play basketball like before. I’m sorry.”

I was devastated. The whole world crashed down on me.

“How could this happen to me!”

I could not help but burst into tears like a baby. This was not fair!

A few weeks later, I was discharged from the hospital. I could not wait to get into court with my friend, Jimmy. I did not heed my doctor’s advice to refrain from strenuous activities.

“Hey, let’s go for a match!” I said over the phone.

“Sure!” Jimmy responded.

At the basketball court, I tried to dribble the ball past Jimmy. However, the pain pulsated through my leg with every step I took. Even when I tried to slow down, it did not help. I stopped in my tracks despondently.

“No, Jimmy, this is too difficult. I cannot even run with this leg. It’s too painful.”

“Jerry, you’ve just been discharged from hospital. Don’t take it so hard! Injuries take time to recover,” Jimmy said, but I would not listen to him.

I limped off the court, disappointed at the state I was in. From that day on, I did not go near the court or even talk to Jimmy. I also refused to go for any physiotherapy. I stayed cooped up in my own room, day after day. Consumed by misery, I spent most of my time sleeping and playing video games, trying to stop myself from thinking about basketball.

One day, I heard the doorbell ring. I opened the door, and Jimmy was outside.

“This is for you, Jerry!” Jimmy held out a box cheerfully.

“What’s this?” I asked curiously, opening the box in a hurry.

To my surprise, it was a limited edition ‘Michael Jordan’ jersey.

“Well, I know that Michael Jordan is your idol. He overcame many obstacles to become who he is today. I hope that you will not give up on basketball. The whole team is waiting for you. We believe you will come back stronger!” Jimmy said, beaming with positivity.

Those words warmed my heart. Tears rolled down my cheeks.

“Thank you, Jimmy. This is the best present ever. I will not give up,” I promised.

The following day onwards, I resumed my physiotherapy sessions and did some light exercises. Soon, I could manage my pain, and I regained part of the strength in my legs. Three weeks later, I could even run and jump without any issues. My confidence returned, and I even shot a few hoops one day on my way home from the hospital.

Dr Lee, amazed at the speed of my recovery, asked, “How did you get back on your feet so quickly?”

“Well,” I said, grinning, “it’s all because of a special present.”

Caius Chin, P6

Topic: Receiving Bad News

Pictures given: A phone, A letter, A woman looking shocked

"Where is Sally? Why is she not back yet?" Sally's mother, Mrs Tan, thought, looking at the door every second. "She said she would be home in two hours' time!"

Just as she was fretting over this, the phone rang. The screen did not display any contact name or number. It simply showed 'Unknown'. Hurriedly, Mrs Tan answered the call.

"Hello? Sally? Is that you?" she asked hopefully.

"We have got your daughter. Pay us ten thousand dollars in three hours from now!" yelled a gruff voice from the other end of the line.

Mrs Tan dropped her phone in shock.

"Ah!" she screamed, hands on her mouth and eyes locked on the phone.

Mrs Tan kept calling her husband, but she could only reach his voice mail.

"Hi, this is Ben. I'm not free now. Please leave a message!"

"Ben! Our daughter has been kidnapped! Call me back as soon as you hear this!" Mrs Tan cried.

Minutes ticked by, but Ben did not return her calls.

"He is busy at work again? Oh no… What should I do now?" Mrs Tan muttered.

Naturally, she called the police.

"My daughter hasn't come back home, and a caller told me that they have kidnapped her!" Mrs Tan's voice shook.

"Madam, please calm down. It might be a case of a kidnapping scam. You will need to wait for 24 hours before we can file a missing person report," the policewoman said.

After thanking the policewoman, Mrs Tan waited. The house was quiet once again. In fact, the silence was deafening. The more she waited in the empty house, the more distraught she got. Mrs Tan paced back and forth, praying that the doorbell would ring, and her daughter would be back safe and sound.

"Ring… Ring…"

It was the phone again. The word displayed was 'Unknown'.

"Why is this happening to me?" Mrs Tan said, tears rolling down her cheeks.

As she picked up the phone with trembling hands, she stared at it. Could it be Sally? Could it be my husband? Or even worse… the kidnappers? She pressed the answer button and put it close to her ear.

"Mother! Help me!" a familiar voice screamed.

The hair stood on the back of Mrs Tan's neck.

"Want to get your daughter back? Pay the money now!" growled the scary gruff voice again.

"Okay! How do I pay?" Mrs Tan said frantically. "Please don't hurt my daughter!"

The kidnapper gave Mrs Tan the bank account details. She hurried to the computer to do the money transfer

"I have no choice… Doing this will save Sally," she thought while filling in the details on the computer. Click! The money was transferred. Tears streamed down Mrs Tan's cheeks.

Seconds later, there was the sound of keys jingling at the door.

“Mother, I’m home!” Sally said as she opened the door. Mrs Tan rushed out of the room and stared at her daughter incredulously.

“I thought…you are…”

Before she could complete the sentence, Mrs Tan fainted from relief, stress, and shock.

Trinity Lau, P6

Topic: A Charity Drive

Pictures given: A donations tin, A box of food with the words 'Food Drive, A red car with a sign that reads 'Car Wash'

Sighing helplessly, I gazed at Kate and pouted. She too, had a pained expression on her face. I peered into our tins and shook my head in disappointment. All we had were a few pathetic ten-cent coins! Checking my watch, I slapped my forehead. After two hours, all we managed to get were a few measly cents. We had to do something about this predicament…

It had all begun a week ago, just after our year end examinations. Our brilliant class monitor came up with the idea of holding a charity drive and everyone agreed. After all, there was nothing else to do after the examinations.

After a few days of spirited discussion, we finally decided to hold a donation drive. We were supposed to pair up and station ourselves at the entrances and exits of train stations all around Singapore. Exhilarated, I paired up with my bosom buddy, Kate. Our form teacher was pleased to hear that we were carrying out such a meaningful event and motivated us by introducing a mini-competition. The pair that collected the most money would win prizes! Thinking it was a piece of cake, I smirked with confidence. The prizes were ours for sure!

On the day of the activity, we were given tins as well as stickers. The tins were meant to hold the money while the stickers were to be given to those who donated. Being shy girls, Kate and I stood quietly at the entrance of a train station and presented our tins to anyone who walked past.

We thought that people would instinctively donate money, but they simply walked on as if we were invisible to them. To make matters worse, a few people teased us,

while others rolled their eyes in mild annoyance. Only one kind soul dropped a few ten-cent coins into my tin and left with a sticker.

Our spirits dampened, we stared forlornly at our tins. Two hours passed in a flash, leaving us with little success. We had to think of a better approach.

Gesturing to Kate for her to come over, I suggested, “We have to be more vocal. Let’s persuade every single passer-by individually.”

Kate nodded, and we began working again.

Confidently, I strode over to a man and began my little speech. “Hello, sir. Would you like to donate money to help –”

“No! No!” he shouted impatiently while waving his hand. “I don’t have time for this!”

Some people turned to stare at the tight-fisted man in disbelief for a split second before continuing in the direction they were heading towards. I, too, stood there in momentary silence, shocked by his rude retort. Unfazed by the man’s harsh words, I approached another passer-by, this time a middle-aged woman.

Taking a deep breath, I asked, “Hi, would you like to donate to orphans in Cambodia?”

To my surprise, she nodded enthusiastically and stuffed a fifty-dollar note into the tin. She then strolled off with a sticker which she proudly pasted on her handbag. I grinned. Speaking to strangers was not that hard after all! We were one step closer to success!

Hence, we continued with this method of soliciting donations. Although we got rejected several times, most of the people whom we approached would donate some change when they heard our appeal.

After a day of hard work stepping out of our comfort zones, we had collected almost five hundred dollars from many generous strangers. Our form teacher calculated all the money the class collected and announced Kate and I as the winners! Beaming radiantly, we received our prizes – sweets and two stuffed toys, one for each of us.

Somewhere in the rural areas of Cambodia, orphans were starving. However, with the money collected by us, their lives would change. All our sweat and toil were worth it. It is certainly true that success is meant for those who thought of solutions to problems and more importantly, never give up in the face of adversity. This charity drive taught me an important life lesson that only experience, not textbooks, could teach.

Isabelle Ong, P6

Topic: Being Thankful

Pictures given: A ring, A 'Thank You' note, A gift box

I tried to hold back my tears. Where was it? Where could it be?

"Sorry, give me a while," I politely muttered to the customer trying to order my dumplings.

I hurried to the storeroom and swung the door open. There was the box! I thought. I gingerly took it up. It just might be there. My heart was pounding nervously. I opened the lid of the box. Nothing.

My soul dampened. Quickly scurrying back to the counter, I took the customer's order, while my distracted mind wandered elsewhere.

The alarm in my phone chirped. I flipped the sign on the door to 'closed'. Then, I retraced my steps to areas in the store where I had been in the morning. Despite racking my brain hard, my search was fruitless. I sighed. I had no appetite for dinner. That gift was the last thing my mother had given me before she passed away.

"Mummy!" I had frantically cried beside her bed when I was a child. Sad memories from the past flooded my mind. Finally, tears of sadness trickled down my cheeks. With my face buried in my hands, the combined emotions of worry, anxiety and fear overwhelmed me.

"Ring!"

A teenager stepped into the store. He was huffing and puffing.

"Is…this…yours?" he gasped in between breaths.

Still sniffling, I glanced up. In the teenager's hand…was my beloved ring! My eyes lit up instantaneously. Taking the ring from his hand, I slid it into my index finger. By now, I was sobbing uncontrollably. But, this time, it was tears of joy.

"Are you okay, madam?" the kind teenager asked.

"Yes…yes…thank you… thank you… for the…ring," I sputtered and stammered, sniffling between words.

I let him inside my stall. My heart was filled with thankfulness for this teenager.

That teenager started to explain, "I was eating your dumplings when…"

That was when I realized that his face was familiar. He had ordered dumpling from me a few hours ago!

"…I bit into your ring. I was taken aback. As I had seen it on your hand, I instantly knew that it was yours. So, I came back to return it."

I was thankful for this kind soul. I had never met someone with such a heart of gold before. Choosing five of the best dumplings, I put them into a plastic bag.

"Here," I trusted it into his hands. "This is to express my thankfulness and gratitude."

The teenager tried to decline politely but I was insistent.

"Just take it. It's the only thing I can do to repay you."

The teenager finally caved in.

"Alright," he relented, taking the bag.

Had the teenager not returned the ring, I would have felt like an entire part of my life was lost.

Walking back to the storeroom, I had one last thing to do. I took the gift box and lifted the cover gingerly. The inner azure blue coating made me sigh in relief. I gently slipped the ruby ring out of my finger. I gazed at the words engraved on the inner side of the ring that read, "For my dear Angie".

“You will never go missing again …” I murmured under my breath.

I placed the ring inside the box where it belonged and closed the lid on a chapter of my life.

Ren Cher, P6.

Topic: A Bad Neighbour

Pictures given: "Throw Your Rubbish in the bin" sign, Loud Music/Sound blaring from a speaker, A spray can

"I'm finally done with my homework," I murmured to myself as I glanced at the clock and saw that it was already three o'clock in the morning. I slammed my math notebook shut and dived into my bed. Just as I was entering dreamland, someone started belting out lyrics to a heavy metal song. I groaned and buried my head in my pillow.

All had been peaceful until our new neighbour, Jerry, moved in. Everything had been fine until he started to reveal his true colours. After a few nights, all the other neighbours walked around with dark eye circles because of Jerry's inconsiderate acts. He would blast heavy metal music late in the night, jerking us awake and making us unable to enter la-la land again.

Not long after Jerry had moved in, we came home only to be welcomed by bright red paint announcing to people he owed large amounts of money – of course the work of loan sharks. We found out that Jerry was a gambling addict who had borrowed large sums of money to feed his addiction. All of us were frustrated as we were never able to get a wink of sleep. Whenever we saw Jerry, he would be wearing the same old torn t-shirt and muttering lucky numbers under his breath.

In a short time, Jerry had become infamous all over the neighbourhood. The only people that were happy to see him were the people working behind the lottery counter. They would rub their hands gleefully as Jerry handed over large stacks of money, placing bigger bets every time he came. Every time he found out that he had not won anything, he would hit the wall in his frustration and swear loudly. All the parents would quickly shield their children when they crossed paths with Jerry as they were afraid that he would harm them. We had all tried to stop his actions as all our performances in

schools and offices was deteriorating. Although we had reported him numerous times and he had been fined heavily, the problem was still not solved. My mother was at her wit's end when she found out that our walls had been sprayed red again.

As fatigue overcome me, I snapped back to reality. I sighed as I plugged in to my earphones. It was going to be a long night ahead.

By Jolene Tan

Topic: A Touching Moment

Pictures given: A slice of cake, two hands cupped together, Two people hugging

I stepped out of the school gates only to notice the change of weather. An ominous sky the colour of ash greeted me. I noticed a flash of lighting from far away. The rumbling of thunder followed. Within seconds, fat droplets of rain spilled from the clouds. The pitter-patter of raindrops reached my ears. I stepped back into the sheltered school compound and sighed heavily.

“Looks like it is going to be another rainy day ahead,” I thought. I reached into my bag for my old, blue umbrella and opened it before walking out once more. Thankfully, my house was near the school and it probably would not take long to get home.

Small puddles, like miniature lakes, formed on the ground. Every now and then, I would hear “splish” and “splash” as people stepped into the water. I avoided the puddles as much as possible, as I was wearing my new shoes and I did not want to get them ruined. Knowing that accidents are bound to happen on such a wet and slippery day, I hoped inwardly that no one would need help on my way home. With a ton of homework to finish, I had to get home quickly. Helping someone would delay me, I mused.

Soon, my block was in sight. I quickened my pace, while being careful not to slip and fall.. I wondered what tasty dishes my mother would have whipped up at home. Maybe braised eggs with rice… Or fish soup… Or even my favourite poached eggs with noodles…

“Somebody… please help me…” A feeble voice croaked out from nearby.

Who was that?

“Help, someone…” that voice came again, more distinct. I followed the feeble croaks that I heard. Eventually, I ended up at the void deck of a nearby block. But the person calling for help turned out to be none other than my enemy, Jess.

Jess had always been green-eyed of me as I surpassed her in every way. She was a snobby girl, thus no one wanted to be friends with her. She was jealous that I always did better in examinations than she did. She was jealous that I had many friends around me. She was jealous that I was the teacher's pet. Now what could have happened to her this time?

"Jess, are you alright?" I questioned as I approached her.

"I think I sprained my ankle…" she said in agony. Her face was pale, and she had no strength to move.

I helped her up and propped her against one of the pillars. I asked her what had happened. She explained that she had fallen on her way home, which was a few blocks away. Unfortunately, she had forgotten to bring her umbrella along and was soaked to the skin. With the fall, things were even worse. She had hobbled all the way to the void deck to seek shelter.

I put her arms around my shoulder and told her, "Tell me where your house is. I will shelter you home."

Jess pointed towards a nearby block of flats and directed me to her house. Slowly but surely, we made our way to Jess's home.

When we reached the void deck of Jess's house, she bade goodbye to me. She assured me that she would be fine from there. However, I insisted that I see her to her home.

Suddenly, Jess leaned forward and enveloped me in a bear hug.

"Thank you, Alice," those three words came out from her mouth. "I… want to apologise for my behaviour in the past…I had always been envious about you because you seem so perfect in every way…Will you forgive me?"

I was momentarily stunned. I could not believe my ears as I heard those words. Surely, she would not say that? And much less, the hug. But it was true. I was not dreaming.

"Let's be friends, Jess. I forgive you," I replied as I gushed warmly. I saw her home and said, "From now on, if you have any troubles, come and find me." Jess agreed happily.

As I left Jess, I realised that a part of myself was already drenched and I was thirty minutes late on my schedule! But that did not matter. I had helped someone today, and

experienced a touching moment. My heart was warmed by what Jess did moments ago. With my kindness, I had turned an enemy into a friend.

As I walked home, I smiled to myself. The rain subsided, and a rainbow appeared in its place. It felt like even the heavens were smiling down on me.

By Cheryl Ng, P5

Topic: Trying Something New

Pictures given: Rock-climbing, A baking apron, Snorkelling gear

Gasping in awe, I stared reverently at the bulking, fifty-foot tall structure looming before me. Protruding from the ground like an immense, massive earthen spire, I faltered under the rock wall's penetrating glare, flinching ever so slightly. Why did I have to do this?

"Bye, Mum!" I boomed, as my thunderous voice reverberated throughout the dining hall. Saddling my backpack, I made my way to school as I thought of all the fun I would have during my camping trip.

The cacophony of the students' chattering engulfed the entire hall. Teachers started taking attendance, before we set off on our journey to Kuala Lumpur. Once we arrived at our destination, the breath-taking view of the campsite awed me. We were surrounded by lush greenery and tall trees. Flowers on the meadow attracted colourful butterflies and the tall grass waved in the breeze. The tamed wind caressed my skin gently.

Bringing us over to the rock wall, the instructors went through the procedures of rock climbing and called us out one by one to try this new activity. My heart palpitated erratically against my chest the moment I saw how high the rock wall was. I always had a fear of heights and I was not sure if I could survive this ordeal or not.

"John Tan!" the instructor yelled.

I gulped. I muttered a prayer.

"Please don't let me fall and break my bones…"

Then, I shuffled timidly toward the huge, looming wall.

As I got into my climbing gear, I started scaling the rock wall at a snail's pace, not wanting to make any wrong move. All the other students watched with bated breaths. Trying to ignore the sweat that was stinging my eyes, I pressed on. By now, I was only one foothold away from the top of the rock wall. However, I could feel the exhaustion creeping into my trembling arms, and my legs protesting in pain. To see how far I have reached, I made the horrendous mistake of looking down.

My jaw dropped in a heartbeat and my brain froze. My eyes bulged comically as I stared blankly at the ground. The icy fingers of terror tightened its grip around my heart. I was about ten meters above ground! I hugged the foothold tightly, not wanting to fall off.

"You can do it, John!" my classmates cried out from below.

Motivated by their words, I snapped out of my stupor. I hoisted myself with a final burst of energy and reached the top of the wall.

"I did it!"

In life, there are plenty of things for us to try. We need to face them bravely and overcome our fears. Trying something new has helped me gain some experience in rock-climbing and overcome my fear of heights.

Darren Tan, P6

Topic: An Unexpected Incident

Pictures given: A skateboard, A dog, An open lock.

"What?" I sputtered, confused by the state of the house.

"Well, I think that is the truth, but I still can't figure out how they did it," said my colleague, Bernard.

I sighed. If only I had not chosen to undertake such an impossible case…

"Help! Someone burgled my house! I was at the front door trying to open the lock with my key when I realised that it was already unlocked! The lock was hanging on the door handle!"

I was comfortably resting on one of the cushioned chairs when a call of help came through the telephone.

I groaned involuntarily. It was probably another case of burglary. The recent spate of thefts had evoked concerns from the public but we, the police, could make no head or tail of the situation!

Just as I was about to get up reluctantly for another tedious combing of the scene of crime, my best friend and colleague, Bernard, who answered the telephone just now, beckoned to me.

"Hey, buddy, this case is somewhat different from the rest. The house belonged to the filthy rich man, Mr Phua. It was said that not a single piece of furniture left behind! Yet, not a single soul from the neighbouring houses spotted anything suspicious!" Bernard whispered, his eyes lighting up with incredulity.

Intrigued, I quickened my pace and soon, we arrived at the house. The moment I stepped in, my jaw dropped. The living room was completely bare. What? How could it be possible to ransack this whole house, not make a single sound, and get away with it like a ghost!

Puzzled, I looked around but could not spot any signs of forced entry. Only a lock dangled forlornly on the door handle. An elderly man who was slumped against a wall caught my eye. As I approached him, I could recognise that he was Mr Phua. The moment he lay his miserable eyes on me, he started blubbering.

“Do you know how much loss I suffered? I lost ten gold necklaces, fifteen emerald ones, a pearl bracelet as well as many other precious gemstones! Even my furniture was branded, and these burglars are so heartless. They had to steal every single item! Oh, please solve the case…” he moaned.

My brows furrowed in frustration after listening to the old man’s words. This was an impossible case! The suspects hid their tracks so well that the forensic workers only found traces of the old man’s fingerprints and the tears that he shed.

Just as I was beginning to despair, the front door burst open. A young lady, with a striking resemblance to Mr Phua, claimed that she was his daughter. On seeing the police swarming the house, she had hurried over, fearing for the worst. With a sombre expression, I explained everything to her.

To my surprise, she threw back her head and laughed like a wild woman after hearing our tale. I was puzzled beyond words! How could a person still laugh when her house had been ransacked and her wealth robbed?

Catching her breaths in between fits of hysterical laughter, she finally calmed down to tell us what was so funny.

"My father's memory has been failing. He owns several landed properties around this area. The one that you are searching now is not even refurbished at all! This is not the one that he is living in now!"

I just gawked at her upon hearing that. My colleagues and forensic workers all heaved a sigh of relief. We had just wasted the whole morning solving a non-existent burglary! Soon, dazed Mr Phua was dragged back to his house by his daughter. He yelled that we were insane ones and we had better find the culprits to recoup his wealth soon. His daughter cast an apologetic look over her shoulder.

That was truly the most hilarious yet unexpected incident that I have encountered. I had thought that solving that case would take us ages! Instead, just a simple explanation from Mr Phua's daughter and the "mystery" was solved! How could a police inspector have ever imagined that a case was due to an old man's failing memory?

Charity Lim, P6

BONUS: Tales of Superpowers

Nominated for a Compo Writing Competition

No video games. No Wifi. No television. Nothing.

Timothy's mother had left for work, but she had confiscated the phone and unplugged the television and Wifi. His mother did not trust him. He always played too much, so his mother banned him from such electronic devices. He sighed in boredom.

"I wish I had superpowers. I wish a genie would just appear and grant me three wishes," Timothy mumbled.

Suddenly, there was a puff of smoke and a genie came out of a souvenir lamp that was displayed on a shelf in the living room. His mum had bought that lamp during a recent trip to Egypt. The genie said that he would grant Timothy two more wishes. (The first one had already been used when he wished for a genie to appear.)

Now is my chance to wish for a superpower, he thought.

Without hesitation, he said, "I wish I have the superpower to turn electronic devices on without a power source."

Immediately, the television turned on. Timothy was so excited that he forgot about his other wish, so the genie returned to his lamp.

The next day, Timothy woke up and got ready for school. He brushed his teeth, ate his breakfast and walked to school at 7.15 a.m. Then, he noticed something strange. The street lamps were all turning on automatically.

Oh no! It must be my powers, he thought.

In school, everybody's calculator could not turn off. That befuddled all the teachers and students. At home, Timothy was watching his mother cook (as his phone was confiscated again). Without warning, the induction cooker got so overheated that the plastic handle on the pot became scorching hot and his mother got burnt. He was beginning to think that his powers caused more harm than good.

Days passed, and the same things happened again. The street lights and his schoolmates' calculators remained switched on, and his mother got burnt while cooking again. After much consideration, Timothy decided that he did not want to hurt his mother anymore. He wanted his normal life back so he decided to get rid of his powers.

He tried all sorts of ways to get rid of his powers but failed. He even tried draining his powers away by putting his finger into a socket. But it seemed like his powers would never run out. He felt like giving up, so he lay on the couch feeling crestfallen. Just then, he saw the Egyptian lamp and remembered that he still had one more wish.

He approached the lamp and gave the command, "I wish that my powers are gone!"

The very next moment, he could not turn on the television. Drats!

From that day onwards, Timothy learnt a very valuable lesson—superpowers are not always good and you should just appreciate who you are. Trying to change things can sometimes come at a cost.

By Ryan Loh, P6

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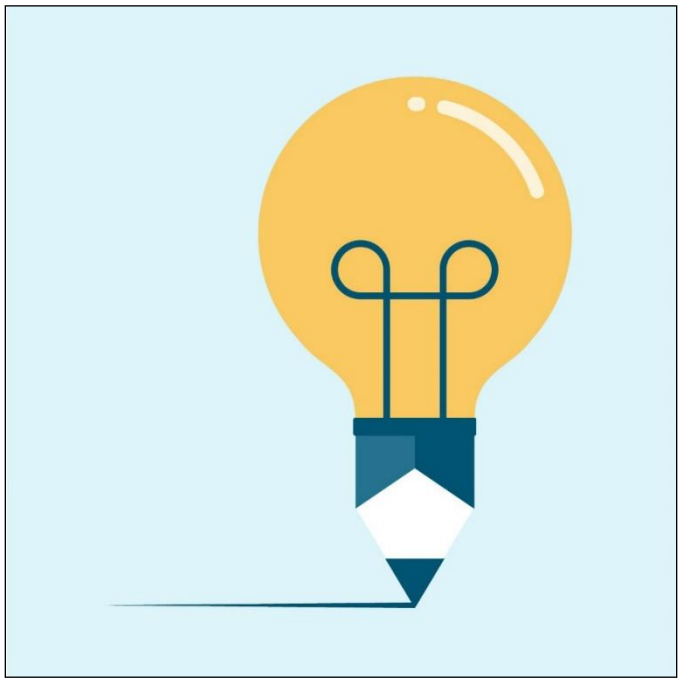

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